
GCVE-BCP-04 - Recommendations and Best Practices for ID Allocation

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1 Recommendations and Best Practices for ID Allocation



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1.1 Introduction

This document describes the best practices and recommendations for ID allocation and GCVE identifier format.

1.2 GCVE Identifier Format

The GCVE identifier typically follows a traditional four-part format:

`GCVE-<GNA-ID>-<YEAR>-<UNIQUE-ID>`

1.2.1 Format Breakdown

If a GNA chooses to use an alternative format, it must still follow this general prefix structure:

The **GNA-VALUE** should be composed of valid 7-bit characters, excluding unprintable control codes and spaces.

When defining a generic GNA value, GNAs should keep in mind the following considerations:

- The GCVE standard allows a certain level of flexibility in how information is conveyed, but it is strongly recommended to maintain a reasonable degree of readability.

[illegible]

- [GCVE-65535-2021-XX-\[222\]_XX{1}/1/1/1](#)
- [GCVE-65535-2021-XX-\[222\]_XX{1}\1/1\1](#)
- [GCVE-65535-GHSA-jc7w-c686-c4v9](#)
- [GCVE-65535-jc7w-c686-c4v9](#)
- [GCVE-65535-ababcbbe.onion-1](#)
- [GCVE-65535-Ivanti/Avalanche-1](#)

The GNA ID 65535 is reserved as a test GNA ID, as defined in the [GCVE directory](#).

1.2.2 Identifier Length

The maximum length for a GCVE identifier is **255 characters**. This ensures compatibility and reliable handling across different software systems.

The reference implementation, [Vulnerability-Lookup](#), supports longer identifiers, but keeping identifiers within 255 characters facilitates integration across diverse toolsets. Nevertheless, it is recommended to keep identifiers within **255 characters (including the prefix)**. - If your regular expression engine supports positive lookahead assertions (most do), `^(?=.{8,255}$)GCVE-[0-9]+-[\x22-\x7E]+$` also accounts for a maximum length of 255 characters. For strict POSIX compliance (no lookahead assertions), `^GCVE-[0-9]+-[\x22-\x7E]{1,247}$` will be mostly accurate with reasonable performance and readability.

1.3 Allocation of GCVE Identifiers

A GCVE Identifier must uniquely identify a vulnerability within the scope of a GNA.

GCVE Identifiers are **not limited** to newly discovered vulnerabilities. They may also be used to:

- extend the description of an existing vulnerability (e.g., adding metadata),
- reference a patch or remediation,
- establish a parent/child relationship with another vulnerability (e.g., a fork or variant).

The GCVE model is designed to support **multiple identifiers for the same vulnerability**, providing complementary information or alternative perspectives.

For example, this may occur when:

- vendors disagree on a vulnerability classification,

- independent discoveries are made in parallel,
- additional context is provided by different GNAs.

There is **no single authoritative identifier** for a given vulnerability. Instead, GCVE enables multiple viewpoints, fostering a more decentralized and transparent ecosystem.

We recommend that GNAs include cross-references whenever possible. This applies both to:

- other GCVE identifiers (from the same or different GNAs),
- identifiers from other vulnerability systems.

This cross-referencing supports stronger interoperability and helps build a richer, interconnected knowledge base covering scenarios such as parallel or independent vulnerability discoveries.